The Naturalist Visits

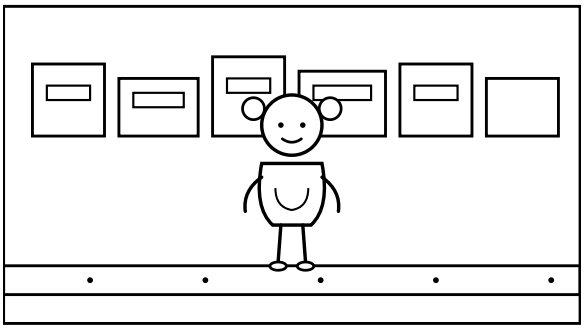
When a hushed old naturalist arrives at the Lost & Found missing the last page of his field journal, hurried young sorter Mira has to slow down enough to discover he's lost something quieter, too.

— color it as you read —

[en]

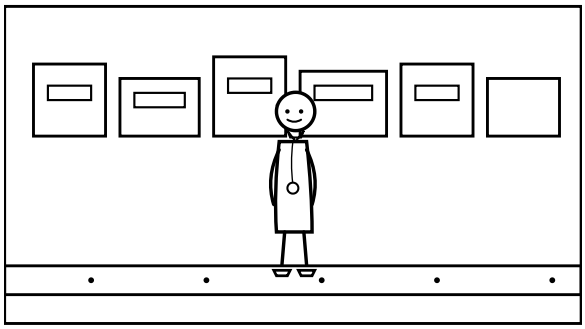
Scene 1 Of 6 **— Sorting Floor**

MEDIUM



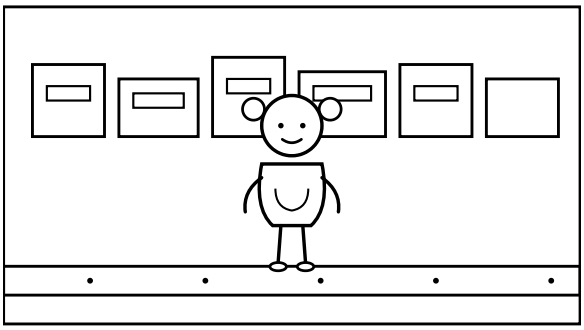
MIRA: Okay-okay-okay! New visitor! Hi! Welcome! What did you lose? A mitten? A name? A wiggly tooth? We get lots of wiggly teeth.

MEDIUM



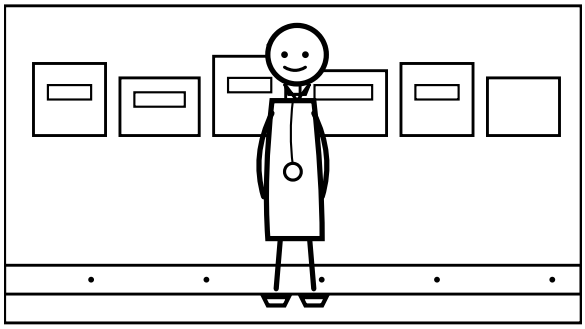
MR. PEMBERTON QUILL: Hello. I have lost… a small page. The last page. From my little book.

MEDIUM



MIRA: A page! Got it. Paper. Last-page-of-a-book. Easy. Color? Size? Pocket-size? Big-as-a-plate?

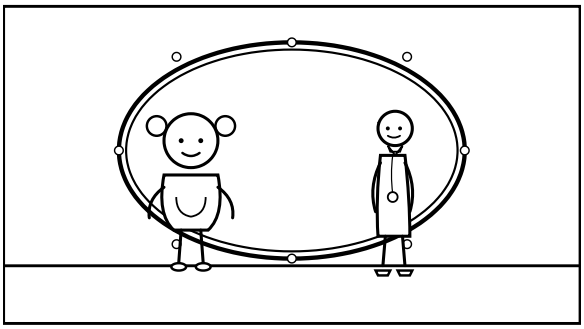
CLOSE



MR. PEMBERTON QUILL: …Pocket-size. With a drawing on it. Of a beetle. A very small beetle, just here—

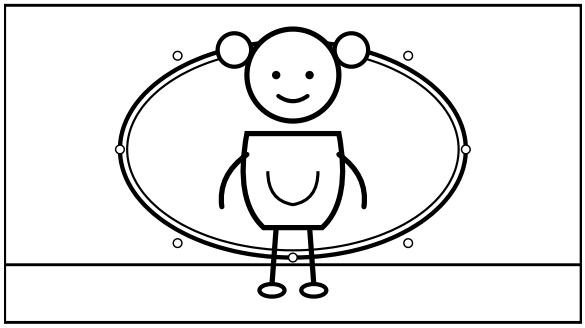
Scene 2 Of 6 **— Window Out**

WIDE



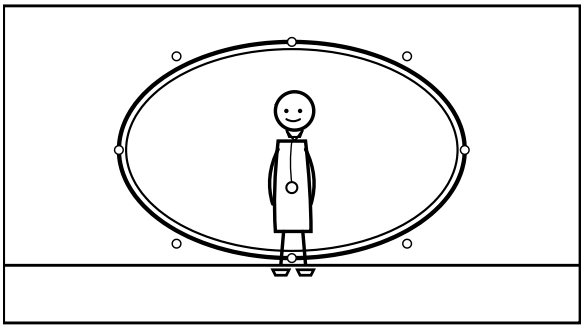
MIRA: The Window Out shows where you lost it. Hold the thing — er, hold the idea of the thing — and look. Ready? Go!

CLOSE



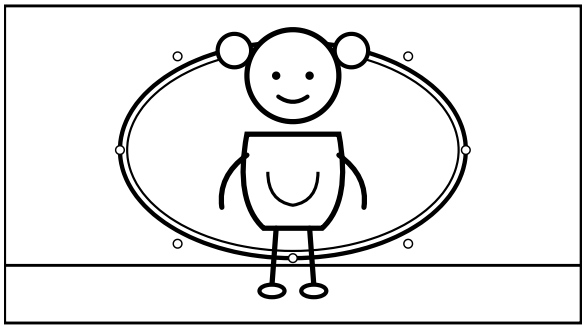
MIRA: Moss. Got moss. Lots of moss. Where's the page where's the page— I don't see paper. I see… leaves. More leaves. Boring leaves. — sorry — interesting leaves.

MEDIUM



MR. PEMBERTON QUILL: …and here, just here, a small thing is waking up.

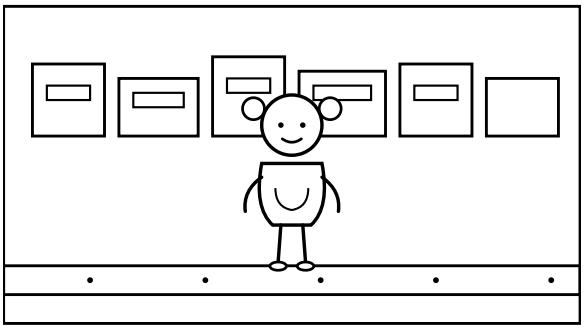
CLOSE



MIRA: What?

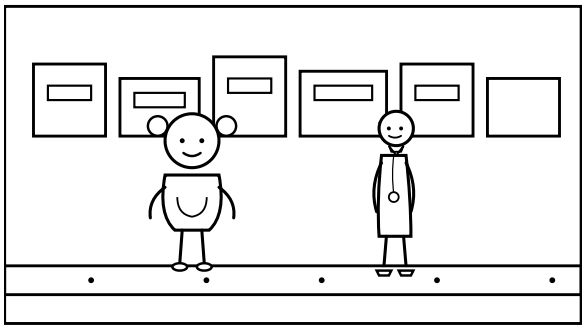
Scene 3 Of 6 **— Sorting Floor**

MEDIUM



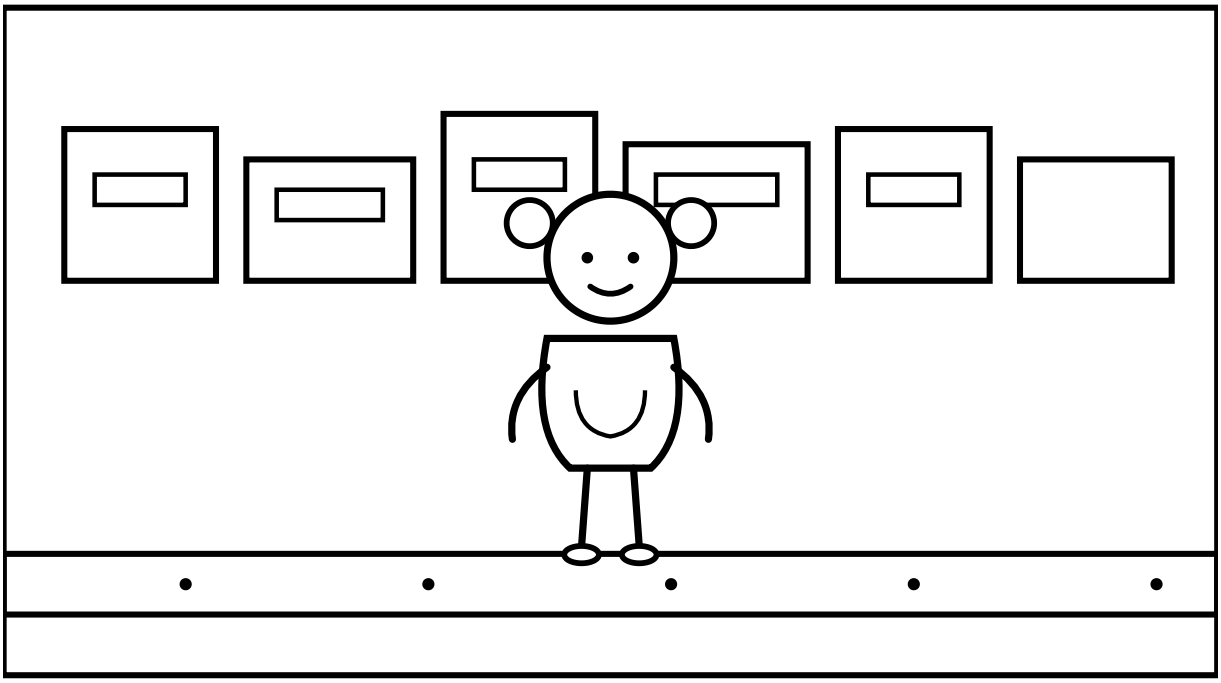
MIRA: Okay-okay-okay, plan! I run the belts, I check the paper bin, I check the drawings bin, I check the beetle-drawings sub-bin, easy peasy—

WIDE



MR. PEMBERTON QUILL: …I think I have lost something else.

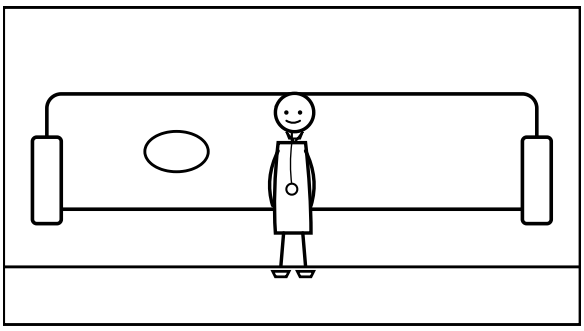
MEDIUM



MIRA: GOT IT! Beetle page! Last page! Mister — Mister Tall-Quiet-Man — I FOUND IT!

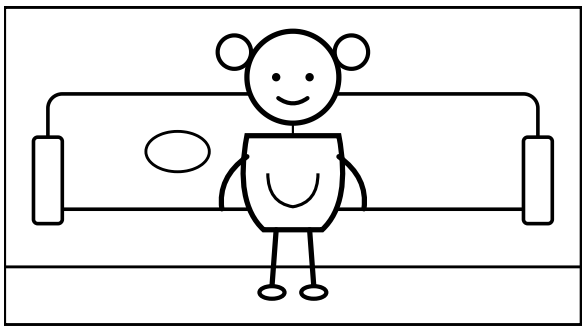
Scene 4 Of 6 **— Comfort Couch**

MEDIUM



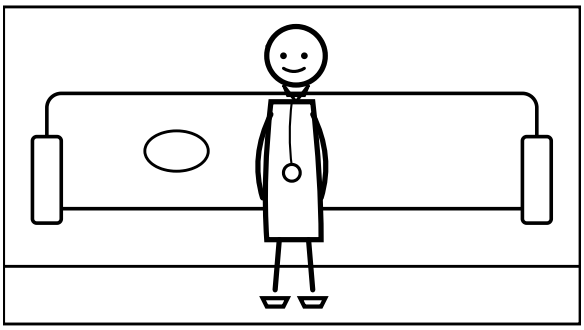
MR. PEMBERTON QUILL: …Thank you.

CLOSE



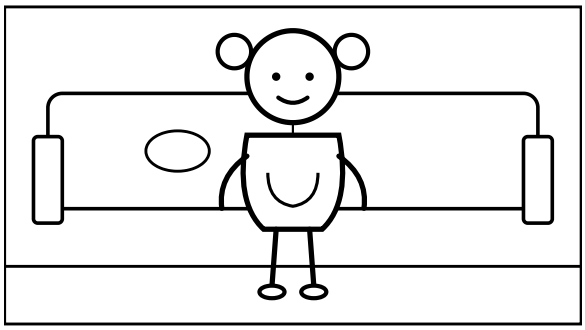
MIRA: …You okay? You don't look done.

CLOSE



MR. PEMBERTON QUILL: No. I do not feel done.

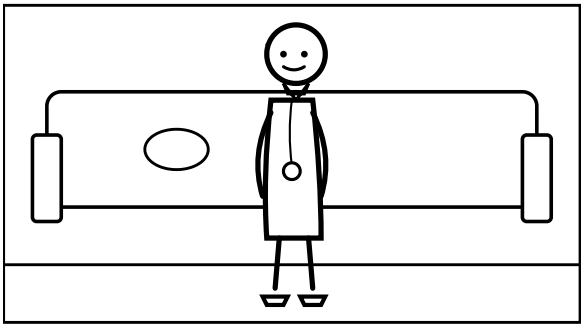
CLOSE



MIRA: Did you lose two things?

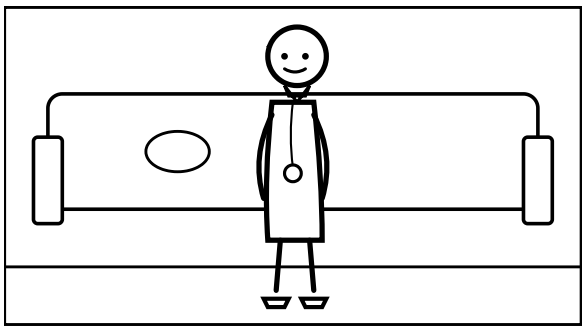
Scene 5 Of 6 **— Comfort Couch**

CLOSE



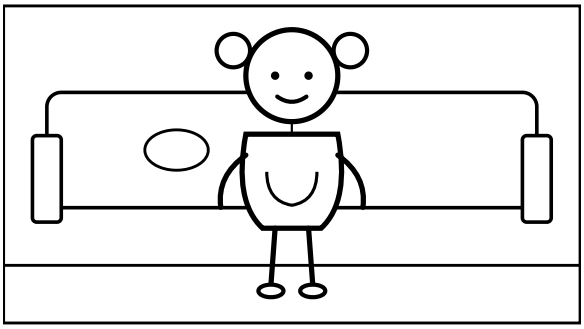
MR. PEMBERTON QUILL: …a drop of water. It rolls. The fern bends. A tiny brown beetle steps out. Its back is shiny. It stops. It thinks a beetle thought. Then it goes on.

CLOSE



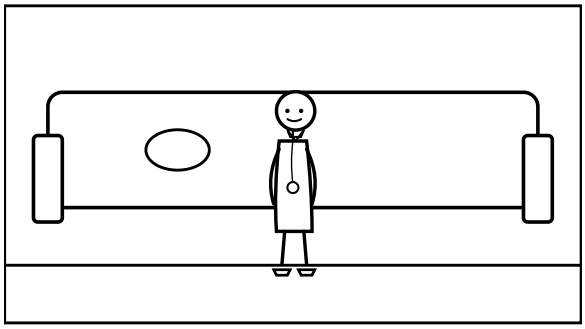
MR. PEMBERTON QUILL: …there it is.

CLOSE



MIRA: There what is?

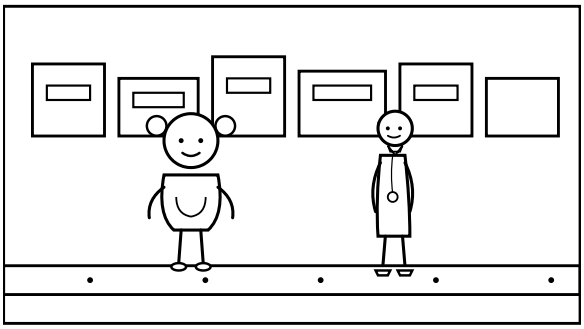
MEDIUM



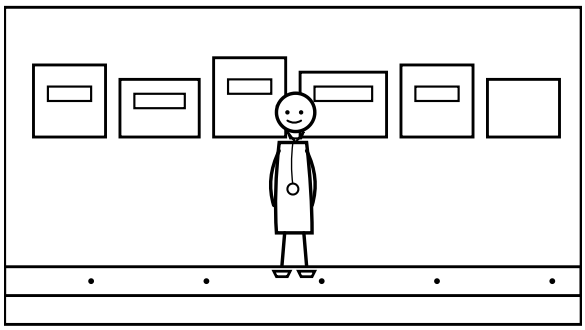
MR. PEMBERTON QUILL: The quiet noticing. It came back. It was here all along. It just needed somebody to sit still with it.

Scene 6 Of 6 **— Sorting Floor**

WIDE

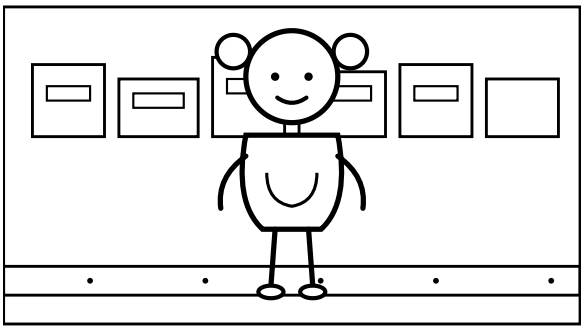


MEDIUM



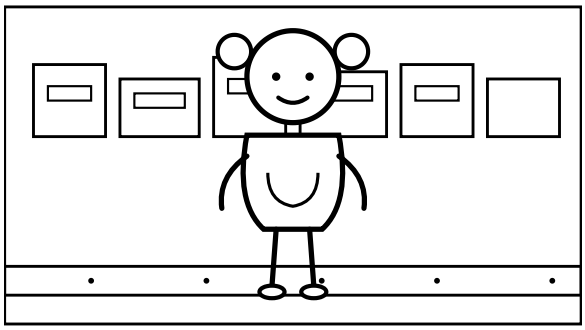
MR. PEMBERTON QUILL: Try it tomorrow. Pick one small thing. A crumb. A crack in the floor. A bit of fluff on a mitten. Look at it for as long as it takes a cloud to move.

CLOSE



MIRA: Okay-okay— …okay.

CLOSE



MIRA: …I noticed you.